

The Role of Integrated Marketing Communication in Banking Services

A Comparative Study of SBI, HDFC, and ICICI in Rourkela

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PROJECT REPORT

Presentation Outline



Introduction

Understanding IMC and its critical role in the modern banking sector.



Bank Profiles

Deep dive into strategies of SBI, HDFC, and ICICI banks.

Project Findings

Methodology, data analysis, and insights from the Rourkela market study.

What is Integrated Marketing Communication ?

IMC is a strategic approach that coordinates all promotional activities to deliver a unified, customer-focused message.

- ✓ **Consistency:** Same message across TV, print, and digital.
- ✓ **Coordination:** All channels support each other.
- ✓ **Customer-Centric:** Focus on the user journey and experience.



Why IMC in Banking ?

Building Trust

Banking is an intangible service based on trust. Consistent messaging reinforces reliability and security.

Differentiation

With similar interest rates and products, how a bank communicates becomes its unique selling proposition (USP).

Cross-Selling

IMC helps in effectively marketing multiple products (Loans, Cards, Insurance) to the same customer base.

Project Scope:

Rourkela

The Steel City Context

Rourkela represents a Tier-2 Indian city with a unique demographic mix of industrial workers, students (NIT), and traders.

Objectives:

- Analyze marketing reach in Sector 19 & Main Road.
- Compare digital vs. physical touchpoints.
- Understand customer trust factors.



State Bank of India (SBI)

"The Banker to Every Indian"

Overview: India's largest public sector bank with a massive network. In Rourkela, it holds the highest trust factor among the older demographic.

Key Strength: Unmatched physical presence and government backing.



SBI's IMC Strategy: Tradition & Trust

Mass Media Dominance

SBI relies heavily on traditional media (TV Commercials, Newspapers) which resonates well with the mass population in Rourkela.

Local Events (Loan Melas)

In Rourkela, SBI frequently organizes 'Loan Melas' and participates in local festivals, creating direct community engagement.

SBI Goes Digital: YONO

YONO (You Only Need One)

- ✓ Integrated lifestyle and banking app.
- ✓ **Strategy:** Promoting convenience to retain younger customers who might drift to private banks.
- ✓ **Rourkela Impact:** Increasing adoption among NIT students and young professionals.



HDFC Bank

"We Understand Your World"

Overview: A leader in the private sector, known for operational efficiency and aggressive sales.

Focus: Customer service, premium banking experience, and rapid digital solutions.

HDFC: Data-Driven & Aggressive



Targeted Marketing

Uses data analytics to send personalized offers (Pre-approved loans) via SMS and Email.



Influencer Campaigns

Collaborates with influencers to reach millennials.
#GoDigitalGoSecure campaign was highly effective.



Merchant Tie-ups

High visibility in Rourkela's malls and electronics stores through cashback offers and EMI branding.



ICICI Bank

"Khayal Aapka" (We Care for You)

Overview: Known for innovation and being the first to introduce many digital banking features in India.

Brand Image: Friendly, tech-savvy, and accessible.

ICICI: Innovation & Emotion



Emotional Storytelling

Ads often focus on family values and ease of life ("Khayal Aapka"), creating a softer, emotional bond with customers.

Tech-First Promotion

Heavy promotion of the 'iMobile' app features. In Rourkela, they target the tech-savvy population aggressively.

Project Methodology

To understand the local impact in Rourkela, a mixed-method study was conducted.

- ✓ **Data Source:** Primary & Secondary.
- ✓ **Sample Size:** 50 Respondents.
- ✓ **Locations:** Sector 19 Market, Main Road, NIT Campus.
- ✓ **Material Collection:** Pamphlets, observing hoardings and ATM branding.

Project Methodology

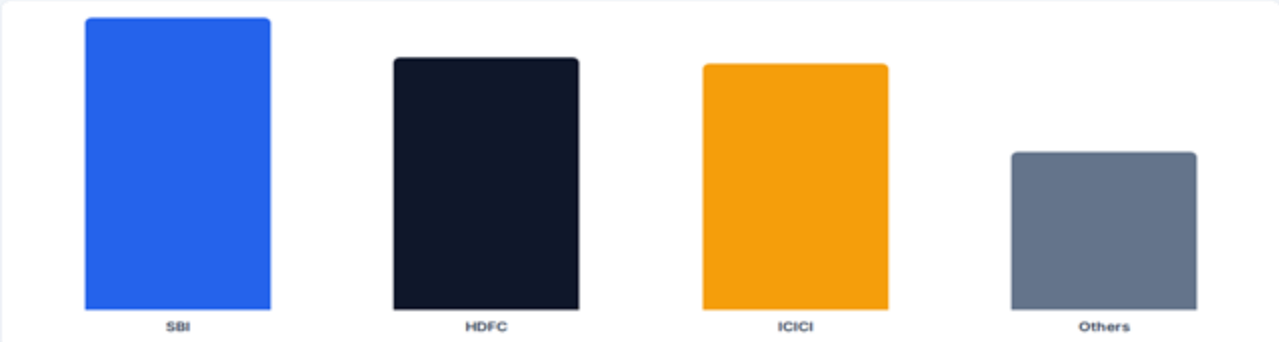
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✓ **Locations:** Sector 19 Market, Road, NIT Campus.



Finding 1: Brand Awareness in Rourkela :



SBI remains the most recognized brand, largely due to its historical presence.

Finding 2: Digital Preference by Age :

Age Group	Preferred Digital Bank	Reason
18-25 (Students)	ICICI / HDFC	App UI, Cashback offers, Speed.
26-45 (Working)	HDFC / SBI	Salary accounts, Home Loan rates.
45+ (Senior)	SBI	Trust, familiarity with "YONO" due to staff help.

Finding 3: Impact of Promotions :

Hoardings

Winner: SBI. Dominates prime locations in Rourkela (Bisra Road, Ring Road) with large vernacular hoardings.

In-Store/Mall

Winner: HDFC. Strong visibility in electronics stores and shopping centers with "No Cost EMI" branding.

Social Media

Winner: ICICI. Viral campaigns and relatable content engage the younger demographic effectively.

Promotional Material Analysis

Physical Evidence from Field

Observation: Physical hoardings in Rourkela often use Odia and Hindi mixed with English to connect locally.

HDFC/ICICI: Focus on product benefits (Rates, Apple Offers).

SBI: Focuses on brand identity and government schemes.



Challenges for IMC in Tier-2 Cities

"For my pension, I only trust SBI. But for my son's education loan and daily UPI, he forced me to open an HDFC account because the app is faster."

- A retired Rourkela Steel Plant employee

Challenges for IMC in Tier-2 Cities



Language Barrier

English-heavy digital ads often miss the older local population. Need for more Odia content.



Digital Literacy

While smartphone use is high, fear of online fraud hinders full adoption of digital banking promotions.



Touch vs. Tech

Customers still value face-to-face interaction over chatbots, making purely digital IMC less effective.

Recommendations

For Private Banks (HDFC/ICICI)

- ✓ Increase physical visibility in local markets (not just malls).
- ✓ Conduct digital literacy workshops to build trust.

For Public Sector (SBI)

- ✓ Improve in-branch customer service to match the marketing promise.
- ✓ Make digital ads more vibrant and youth-oriented.

Future Outlook

The future of IMC in Rourkela lies in **Hyper-Personalization**.

AI and Data Analytics will allow banks to send offers that are relevant to a customer's specific life stage, bridging the gap between digital efficiency and personal care.



Conclusion

Integrated Marketing Communication is not just about ads; it's about Trust.

In Rourkela, SBI leads in trust through traditional reach, while HDFC and ICICI are winning the youth through innovative digital IMC. The ideal strategy for the future combines the **reach of SBI** with the **efficiency of Private Banks**.

Thank You